

Secret Service nets phony money record

Data released by the Secret Service during 1981 budget hearings shows that counterfeiting is on the rise. The statistics, which appear in the agency's 1981 appropriations report, reveal that the amount of bogus currency seized during fiscal 1979 rose by 127 per cent over the previous year.

The Secret Service report shows that \$50.7 million in counterfeit currency was recovered during 1979, 91 per cent of which was seized before it entered circulation. The amount of phony money confiscated last year represents the largest quantity ever recovered.

Based on available data for the first month of fiscal 1980, counterfeiting activities show no signs of diminishing. During this period, a total of \$4.1 million in bogus currency was recovered, with \$3.7 million (representing 90 per cent) confiscated before entering circulation.

Despite aggressive investigation by the Secret Service, counterfeiting takes its toll. During 1979, \$4.5 million in fake money was passed on the public. This represents a 13 per cent increase over the \$4 million of the previous year.

According to the Secret Service, of the \$4.5 million worth of counterfeit currency passed on the American public last year, 70 per cent was traceable to Colombia, South America.

Phony money from Colombia is nothing new. The first counterfeit U.S. currency of Colombian origin was detected by the Secret Service in 1963. Since then, a total of 170 different and distinct counterfeit notes have been identified and catalogued. These are grouped into five major families because they share common workmanship and printing defects.

Colombia has become a significant source of fake U.S. money because of that nation's ineffective, or nonexistent, laws governing the possession or passing of counterfeit foreign currency. The manufacture of phony money in Colombia, however, is prohibited.

With that in mind — and with the cooperation of a Colombian government sympathetic to this country's problem —

the Secret Service established a task force of special agents last year. These agents, working with Colombian authorities in Bogota, were responsible for the arrest of 30 defendants and the seizure of \$26 million in counterfeit U.S. currency. Also recovered in the same raid were 40 million pesos worth of counterfeit tax stamps and 100 million pesos in Colombia bonds.

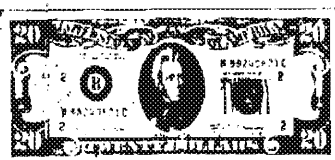
Although all of the U.S. currency produced in Colombia contains noticeable flaws many of the bills which have managed to find their way into circulation often go undetected for long periods of time. According to Secret Service counterfeiting specialist James E. Brown, the reason for this is unfortunately understandable. Because U.S. currency is readily accepted all over the world, when it is accepted, no one really takes the time to examine the notes that are exchanged.

The bulk of the fake U.S. currency seized in Colombia were \$20 bills which were printed by the offset process. That denomination also makes up roughly 78 per cent of the counterfeit currency produced in this country.

Counterfeiters are particular about what they will copy. Although bogus \$50 and \$100 bills are beginning to appear in larger quantities — a fact attributed to inflation — forgers tend to steer clear of the lower denominations. When it comes to \$1, \$2, and \$5 notes, the risk doesn't appear to be worth the effort.

There may be one other reason why one low value isn't very popular among counterfeiters. "We do see \$1 bills on occasion," stated one Secret Service official recently, "but not so much the \$2 bill, probably because many people have trouble now just accepting the genuine ones."

For collectors interested in finding out more about counterfeit currency, the Secret Service has prepared an informative booklet — "Know Your Money" — which is available free of charge. Requests for this item should be addressed to: "The Office of Public Affairs, United States Secret Service, 1606 'G' St., Washington, D.C. 20523."



The counterfeit \$20 bill from Bogota, Colombia

TAP
Room 603
147 W. 42 St.
New York 10036



JUL - AUG 1981 NO. 68

Dear Tap,

Previously, in late 1978, I came across your publication by reading about it in the *Fifth Estate* in Detroit. I bought about half of your back issues and found it very interesting. I would like to resubscribe. Please send your current rates and info so I can buy the other half.

I am particularly interested in Black Boxes and I have several questions about them. First, how does one know when the call coming in is to be black boxed? If a tone decoder such as a 567 was placed on the receiving end and the caller was given a 555 oscillator, the caller could send a beep down the line and trigger the 567 which could turn on a light or buzzer to notify the receiver of a long distance black box call. (I only ask these questions for educational purposes).

In regards to 2600 and black box detectors, it would seem to me that this equipment would be too expensive to place on everyone's line and that only random checks are made. It would seem that Ma would have to get a warrant to bust into one's place and then find the equipment. How could they prove that the voice on the line is the suspect in question? (Even capture of the device would only add to circumstantial evidence).

I believe in issue 36 or 33 there is a reproduction of an ad for a 2600 Hz & black box detector. It states that the device catches black boxes by detecting the presence of an AC signal in the absence of a certain amount of DC current. It also states that the device can be placed in series or parallel.

If the detector is wired in series it states that it can detect 2600 Hz bypassing and black boxing simultaneously. In parallel it can only detect 2600 Hz tones. In order to detect the black box it must be placed in series. This must be necessary to measure current flow while picking up the audio. Consequently, the device may have a significant dc resistance. For instance the device may use a very small miniature relay for current detection. In any case it may have a fairly substantial dc resistance which may alter your voltage or current flow.

The ad also states that the detector is triggered by the presence of AC in the absence of a certain level of DC, why not let just enough DC current to flow; but an amount of DC insufficient to trigger the telco relay — perhaps 14-16 milliamps? If the relay doesn't trigger billing doesn't occur. By placing the current as close as possible one might be able to bypass the detector. If the ringing AC stops, you will know that the relay has triggered.

It has been my experience that the dc resistance of the line (the batteries internal resistance, relay resistance & line itself) is usually around 1500 to 2000 ohms. Consequently, if the device has a resistance of 200 ohms and let's say the phones resistance was 200 ohms and the telco dc impedance was 1500 ohms then the device would alter the voltage from 5.2 to 4.7 a change of approximately 10%. I have sampled my telephone voltages before and they seem to remain fairly constant. One method is to sample the line with the phone disconnected with a precision resistor of 200 ohms. This excludes any ac from the carbon mike. The only ac variance will come from the dial tone which should be minimal. The only other variation would be that of the line resistance which may change slightly with the weather.

Another method of testing might be to send a low power RF signal down the line. The relay being an inductor should provide considerable ac impedance. Any capacity coupling may create an ac short at very high frequencies — this would reduce impedance at high frequencies. An LC bridge will resonate at a specific frequency. If the series hook-up uses an audio transformer this will increase the inductance of the line and once again change impedance at various frequencies. Consequently, a random sampling of a spectrum of frequencies may be taken and recorded. Any variance at a future date should be suspect.

In order to test AC impedance place a high impedance ac meter across L1, L2. Most commercial multimeters have a very low AC impedance. Usually 2K or less. Be sure you check the specs for AC impedance most multimeters have different input impedances for DC voltage, resistance and AC voltage tests. Next connect the signal generator across L1, L2 making sure to use a blocking capacitor. Be sure to disconnect all telephones so the fingers don't interfere with your readings. You should also take readings at random intervals in the lower ranges 1K to 100KHz. Then try RF frequencies going as high as you can with your equipment. When changing frequencies disconnect the generator from L1, L2 and take an ac reading. Calibrate the AC voltage to a uniform value (say 5 volts) each time. Then connect the generator to the line and note how the voltage changes. The voltage will vary depending upon the AC impedance of the telco equipment at each specific frequency. Next keep a record of what you have done. Now you can retest your line from time to time and note variations.

I am in the process of experimenting with this method right now and am keeping records of each test. I am also monitoring my voltage and currents weekly with precision digital equipment. If anyone else out there is interested perhaps we can compare results and devise some new testing methods. If you have an AC current meter you might test the amount of current passing at each frequency also. If anyone has any information on the impedance of detection devices or how they are coupled please send it in and we can figure out a way to detect its presence on the line.

Tom,

Phone machine malfunction cited as cause of blaze

EDISON — A telephone answering machine was cited as the cause of a fire which damaged a Koster Boulevard apartment yesterday morning.

Township Fire Chief H. Ray Vliet said the blaze, which broke out shortly after 9 a.m., apparently began when an automatic telephone answering machine shorted out and ignited wires leading to the device.

The chief said the fire was confined to a table upon which the machine was sitting, some papers and a portion of the wall

behind the table.

He said the small blaze caused some smoke damage to the living room of the apartment, but no extensive damage or injuries.

Albert Gittenman, who rents Apt. 2-C at 14 Koster Blvd., was not at home at the time of the fire, according to the chief.

Members of Raritan Engine Company No. 2 and the Edison Paid Fire Department responded to the 9:06 a.m. call, which was brought under control within minutes of the firefighters' arrival.

LETTERS FROM READERS

Dear Tap

For any Paper Trippers out there who are trying to keep a clean and solid non de plume, some advice: If you are thinking of using credit for your new namesake, beware of TAP credit. They are The Credit Bureau. Although they won't admit to it in their public printed policy, they do keep records of your present and past residences and employment. This could lead to your undoing should you ever want to submerge for a while with your alias intact.

The above tidbit also holds true for everyday people who are trying to get credit. The point is to be sure that you give practically the same story everytime you apply for credit (they like to see 'stability'). Any variations such as different social security numbers or birthdates will be emphasized in your file, and probably will be a red flag to any credit grantors who may wonder about the discrepancies.

Probably the best idea is to request a copy of your own credit file for the last six months (which will be all they will give you). Obtaining it is merely routine and you might be rather amazed at what you could find in your file. One should take this opportunity to "Straighten" out their file. How? That's your problem. Be creative.

Hoping that we all live life with the least amount of hassles. That's true freedom.

Tex's Instruments has done it for us. They are making a "Blue Box". They call it a TI 99/4 Home Computer. It has music capabilities built in. It plays up to 3 tones at a time whose frequency can be specified to the nearest Hz and whose duration can be specified to the millisecond.

When I called TI to ask a few questions about its capabilities, the gentlemen I talked to readily admitted the computer's possibilities. In fact, he used the term "Blue Box" first. He said they originally planned to mention its auto dialing capabilities (touch-tone of course, and not MF) but decided not to after being contacted by, guess who, Ma Bell.

There are 2 disadvantages: 1, It costs \$1100.00; 2, It is bulky. But it means you can have a legal "Blue Box" sitting right in your home and Ma Bell can't do anything about it. Besides it can also play football, chess, and any number of other interesting things.

Hey! Maybe There Is Hope

A federal investigation disclosed last week that a \$100 million computer at a top-secret government weapons laboratory in Albuquerque, N.M., was improperly used by the lab's employees to store such extraneous data as games, personal letters, jokes, an illegal bookie operation for local gamblers and an inventory for someone's beer-can collection.

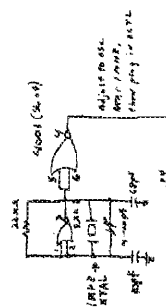
TABLE 1

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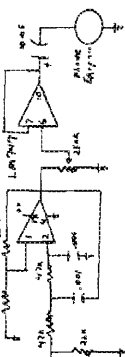
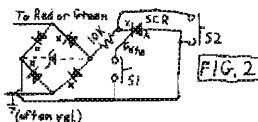
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00000009	61500 0000	169	01010011	776 40
00000010	61500 0000	170	01010012	776 41
00000011	61500 0000	171	01010013	776 42
00000012	61500 0000	172	01010014	776 43
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00000027	61500 0000	187	01010029	776 58
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00000037	61500 0000	197	01010039	776 68
00000038	61500 0000	198	01010040	776 69
00000039	61500 0000	199	01010041	776 70
00000040	61500 0000	200	01010042	776 71
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00000058	61500 0000	218	01010060	776 89
00000059	61500 0000	219	01010061	776 90
00000060	61500 0000	220	01010062	776 91
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STICKY SITUATION. Thieves taking advantage of modern technology are literally "sticking up" their victims by using the new super gloves to steal their hands to write or otherwise while they rob them. It is usually impossible for the stick-up victim to scream without the aid of a device. In England, the British Safety Council has been trying to pass a law banning the sale of super gloves.

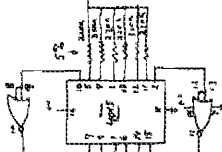
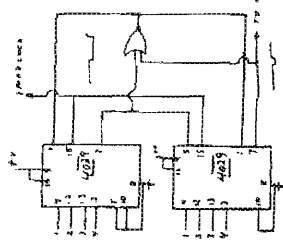
STICKY SITUATION. Thieves taking advantage of modern technology are literally "sticking up" their victims by using the new super glue to stick their hands to walls or furniture while they rob them. It is usually impossible for the stuck-up much-up victims to cry out without the aid of a doctor. In England, the British Safety Council has been trying to pass a law banning the sale of super glue.

[illegible]

As a parting shot, let me tell you that 958 (the NYC City AMI #) and 559 and 470 are often used as test numbers. Try them from a coin phone in your area and tell us what happens. Also try 930 for "Flash" which is usually reserved for new survivors. "Flash #2420" - please contact Ted. "The Doctor" - please contact Mick. _____ We would appreciate any and all feedback.

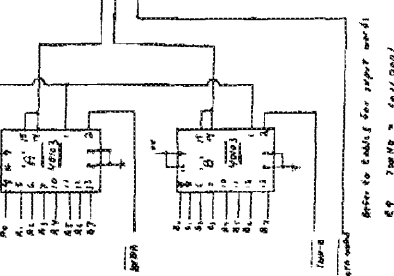


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$$\text{Eq. } 7000 = 101000!$$

BY THE MAGICIAN.....

This column will attempt to bring out interesting developments in the world of high technology. There are lots of areas that TAP has not explored and I intend to open up a few. Maybe there is someone out there who can use this information. Remember, it is important to break into these areas BEFORE they realize that we can do it.

J.C. Welman, Jr., who is the head of the AMERICAN BANKERS ASSOCIATION gasoline-rationing task force, was recently quoted as saying that the "task of consolidating a national vehicle registration data base, issuing gas allocation checks for some 150 million vehicle owners and processing the millions of coupons that would be the currency of rationing could overwhelm the D.P. capabilities of gas-rationing agencies". What this means is that any gas-rationing plan used will have huge loopholes for clever people. Read THE BLACK BAG OWNERS HANDBOOK- FALSE FACE for some good ideas on making bogus ration books.

What is known about the National Law Enforcement Telecommunications System (NLETS)? It's located in Phoenix and is currently replacing its Data General Nova 840 with PDP 11/70's. I know that this will be used with NCIC, perhaps to free them from the public phone network.

Bell (AT&T and Western Electric) seems to be getting ready for a push in the word-processing market. By using their new ESS systems, with store-and-forward message switching, Bell will have a large advantage. All you good Tappers need to help figure out how we can use this service for FREE. The rumors are that Bell can now store a three minute conversation in memory, if so then this could be used for automatic recording of calls that had Blue/Black Box detected.

ITT has a new service for fax machine users. Faxpax will allow any two fax machines to communicate regardless of speed. The article said you can find out who has fax machines by calling the local Faxpax operator. This opens up a whole new dimension in obscene phone calls. There is a free 90 day trial if you contact ITT DTS, 2 Broadway, NY, NY 10004. 212-558-4200. Of course, the Tap staff could just walk down the street and find out.

There will be a new 900 exchange in the near future. It will be used in place of 800 numbers for TV merchandising, etc. Details are few but it seems that the number only exists in the ESS system. A merchandiser makes arrangements with Bell to set up the number at a certain time and keep it up for a specified length of time. It probably saves Bell thousands of dollars by keeping normal long lines free but the assholes want to charge the CALLER 50¢ per call.

Prof. John M. Carroll of the Univ. of Western Ontario is writing about automated crime. He tells of "...a counter-culture group in L.A. that maintains a computer-based hit list of execs of American firms doing business in Latin America and of hit lists of jewelry and valuables and the computerized rigging of odds on horse racing.

About that source code we heard the Russians tried to buy--seems it was the source code for a data base management system (DBMS) sold by ADABAS. ADABAS used the incident for a full-page ad in COMPUTERWORLD.

It seems like the Immigration Service (INS) is a little loose. Senator Richardson Preyer says, "we found that security personnel at INS had never run test raids on its paper and computer records". They had also failed to test means of spotting forged or altered entries on the files. These failures are distressing because of the "large black market in forged documents". Need some papers?

If you want to cut your phone bills, cut out this chart.

Back Issues are \$.50 each. Issue # 50 is \$1.
Subscriptions - 10 issues - US Bulk Rate \$5.
US First Class in plain sealed envelope \$7.
Canada & Mexico First Class \$7.
Foreign Surface \$8. - Foreign Air Mail \$10.
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TAP "10th Anniversary" Pen - \$.50.
TAP Cassette Tape - \$3.50. Hear Capt Crunch, Al Bell, Joe Engrasia, and Bell Security Chief John Doherty.
Send CASH, check, or money order to:

TAP, Room 603, 147 West 42nd Street, New York, N.Y. 10036.

The Bell book "Notes On Distance Dialing" is extremely useful to the "Telecommunications Hobbyist" it contains reams of information on a wide variety of topics ranging from international telephone routing techniques to WATS to CCIS etc. The last edition was priced at \$12.50, but I Believe a new edition is now out, and most likely costs more (Doesn't everything?). For more information on obtaining a copy, send a SASE to TAP.

A note of caution to those of you hacking on SPC SPRINT and MCI. It is believed that Bell has set up all MCI and SPRINT local dialups as "Trap Numbers". This means that whenever you call the dialups, a trouble card is dropped (IE. a record is printed containing the CALLING number and time) at the Bell central office. These "cards" are usually ignored unless MCI or SPRINT detects a fraud (IE. Unauthorized use of a customers access code) then they can call Bell and almost immediately find out the calling phone number and nail the person. Thus dialing MCI or SPRINT from a PAY PHONE would seem to be the only safe way. (By the way, The above mentioned "trap numbers" is also how Bell goes after harrasing phone callers, to private residences.)

Also remember MCI and SPRINT always have a record of the CALLED number. Thus if a customer complains that he is being billed for calls that he did not make, MCI and SPRINT will contact the number called and try to find out who called them at the time in question. So only institutional switchboards, Business's with no record of your call and people with very "short memorys" are "safe" to call through MCI and SPRINT.

PLEASE NOTE: We DO NOT encourage you to rip off MCI or SPRINT as they are in business attempting to provide an alternative lower cost long distance telephone service and are most certainly a step in the right direction!

Mad at IRAN? Well call up the militants at The United States embassy and tell them what you think.

After 9:00 AM Iran time call:

Country Code: 098
City Code: 21 (Tehran)
US Embassy: 825001

Any comments, questions etc. send to:
The Magician C/O TAP

"I don't make jokes, I just watch the government and report the facts and I have never found it necessary to exaggerate." - Will Rogers.

"A newspaper is not just for reporting the news as it is, but to make people mad enough to do something about it." - Mark Twain.



Dear TAP,

This is just a note to let you know how much I enjoyed WATS-80. I would like THE DOCTOR to get in touch with me through the TAP office. The info on SPRINT has been useful, will it be published? I've done a lot of scanning recently and want to add to SOLOS article that xxx-0000 indicates a band 1 prefix. Also if the jane recording greets you at xxx-0050, try xxx-0060 to verify the band 6 prefix you found. Is anyone out there interested in swapping scanned numbers?

TASERS are getting big here. Rumour has it that TAP will be publishing plans soon, well??

Upcoming projects from the think tank include a new box that allows the caller to put money in the phone and get it back. It is possible to use this from the called and with some changes. Look for plans in the winter TAP.

Sept, 80 Popular Electronics turned me on to the ICL7660 voltage polarity converter chip. It should simplify pipers box by eliminating one of the bulky batteries. It also crossed my mind that a 4046 cmos pll could be used to detect 2000 hz, which is used by the man to trace calls. It could be set up for automatic shutoff, even on black box calls.